IMPROVING CALL CENTER OPERATIONS

Certification Planner LLC

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Introduction

Nutri Worldwide Inc. had outsourced the customer interactive services operations to Simple Calling Services (SCS) about 5 years ago. Nutri Worldwide Inc. guaranteed minimum volume of 500,000 calls per year with the rate of Rs.100 per call to ECSL. Since last two years, the service performance of SCS has deteriorated to such an extent that Nutri Worldwide Inc. is considering cancelling the contract with SCS. SCS has been collecting the data on the duration the representatives were available to answer the calls and the hold times. The data for the last few months is shown in Table 1. The performance measures that were of interest to Nutri Worldwide Inc. were:

1. Provide first call resolution to at least 75% of calls
2. Resolve minimum 90% of inquiries within 5 days

Unknown to the call center, Nutri Worldwide Inc. was also monitoring data on the number of people who were unable to get answers from SCS.

The Quality Assurance (QA) department conducts regular inspections of recorded actual conversations between the callers and representatives. A rating based on the relative scale 1-5 is assigned to the calls based on friendliness, accuracy, and suitable advice given to the callers. The table below shows the definition of the ratings:

Ratings	Definition
1	Perfect response
2	Good response
3	Average response
4	Poor response
5	Very bad response

ECSL had 2 QA analysts John and Miranda. It has been observed that the quality check results of the two QA analysts vary sometimes. Therefore, data for 20 voice recordings was collected to verify the repeatability and reproducibility of QA activities. Table 2 shows the results of their assessments for each of 20 voice recordings.

A couple of other problems with SCS are their inability to hold on to the experienced workforce and the amount of time it takes to hire experienced individuals. SCS decides to hire an expert on Six Sigma methodology to help them improve the call center operations and to improve the performance to a level that is acceptable to the client. SCS also wants to ensure that the Average Handle Time (AHT) is maintained during the course of this project. SCS has 6-8 months to turn around the performance of the company or potentially lose contract.

Data Tables

Table 1

HISTORICAL BASELINE DATA (Table 1)							
Month	**Number of Reps**	**Number of Calls**	**AHT**	**First Calls Resolution**	**5 Day Resolution**	**FCR %**	**5DR %**
11-Jan	20	22,858	4.17	16,458	15,822	72.00%	69.20%
11-Feb	20	28,963	3.4	22,910	22,092	79.10%	76.30%
11-Mar	20	23,070	4.91	15,826	16,697	68.60%	72.40%
11-Apr	19	29,933	2.46	26,375	21,454	88.10%	71.70%
11-May	19	26,633	4.49	15,554	19,663	58.40%	73.80%
11-Jun	19	27,638	3.97	21,266	20,788	76.90%	75.20%
11-Jul	19	24,553	2.93	23,167	20,136	94.40%	82.00%
11-Aug	20	29,897	3.27	19,913	22,544	66.60%	75.40%
11-Sep	20	23,418	4.05	16,346	18,788	69.80%	80.20%
11-Oct	21	22,901	3.89	18,756	14,910	81.90%	65.10%
11-Nov	20	22,250	5.59	15,308	15,301	68.80%	68.80%
11-Dec	20	27,482	4.02	16,324	22,585	59.40%	82.20%
12-Jan	20	24,599	4.67	20,366	17,138	82.80%	69.70%
12-Feb	20	24,413	3.14	23,366	14,037	95.70%	57.50%
12-Mar	19	24,840	4.87	16,221	17,691	65.30%	71.20%
12-Apr	19	27,011	3.43	17,368	17,708	64.30%	65.60%
12-May	18	21,166	4.85	17,400	14,749	82.20%	69.70%
12-Jun	18	28,871	3.62	26,417	21,618	91.50%	74.90%
12-Jul	17	22,515	4.19	19,290	18,321	85.70%	81.40%
12-Aug	19	21,244	3.73	14,573	14,191	68.60%	66.80%
12-Sep	20	29,900	4.02	23,727	22,795	79.40%	76.20%
12-Oct	20	20,387	6.08	14,251	14,289	69.90%	70.10%
12-Nov	20	23,906	3.57	18,848	19,047	78.80%	79.70%
12-Dec	20	27,099	4.03	24,026	24,168	88.70%	89.20%

Table 2

Table 2				
Voice Sample	**John Trial 1**	**John Trial 2**	**Miranda Trial 1**	**Miranda Trial 2**
1	3	2	3	3
2	2	2	2	2
3	2	2	2	2
4	4	3	4	4
5	1	1	1	1
6	5	4	5	5
7	4	4	5	4
8	3	2	3	3
9	3	3	3	3
10	4	5	4	4
11	2	1	2	2
12	3	3	3	3
13	5	4	5	5
14	2	2	2	2
15	2	2	2	2
16	2	2	2	2
17	2	2	2	2
18	4	3	4	3
19	3	3	3	3
20	2	2	2	2

Exercises and Time Estimates

Case study reading by the participants (30 min)

Exercise 1 (1 hr)

Process capability Indices

Using the data given in Table 1, determine the process capability indices for performance metric.

'First Call Resolution'. The specification limits for the FCR are; LSL=75% and USL=100%. Provide the appropriate interpretation for the process capability indices drawn, based on the available data.

Exercise 2 (1 hr)

1. What kind of data is shown in Table 2? Which method would you use for measurement system analysis to verify the repeatability and reproducibility of QA results?
2. Determine the potential causes why SCS fails to meet First Call Resolution targets consistently. Brainstorm and propose solutions for elimination of causes for failure to meet FCR targets.

Exercise 3 (1 hr)

FMEA

For the solutions proposed in Exercise 2 above, using learning on FMEA identify potential failure modes and their effects.

***The exercise duration includes working on the exercise and 15 minutes of presentation by participants.